



EGYPTIANS

AT THE ENTRANCE TO AFRICA

THE LIFEBLOOD OF EGYPT IS THE NILE RIVER, which passes through the center of the country. It has enabled many civilizations to flourish, among them the Ancient Egyptians, Nubians, Greeks, and

Bustling metropolis

Egypt's capital, Cairo, is the city with the largest population in all of Africa—over 16 million people live here. There has been a city on this site by the Nile delta since Babylonian times, so ancient monuments jostle with the sprawling modern metropolis. Cairo and its environs are home to the Great Pyramid at Giza and to many ancient churches, mosques, and synagogues.

CAR CITY

Over two million cars travel the streets of Greater Cairo daily, resulting in an almost continual rush hour with traffic so densely packed it barely moves. Parked cars contribute to the chaos: there are only 15,000 parking spaces though at least 45,000 are needed.

FRESH BREAD

This pitta-bread seller is carrying the most simple and basic type of bread. Flour and water are mixed together and baked rapidly in a clay oven. Because it is pocket shaped, the bread can be stuffed with meat and vegetables to form a handy sandwich.

